AWAY FROM THE NATIONAL GLARE, IN PLACES AS DISTANT AS DHAR, SASARAM AND CHIKMAGALUR AMONG MANY OTHERS, **FAITHS COLLIDE AND SEEDS OF HATE ARE PLANTED**

PRAYERS IN CONFLICT

The 15th-century dargah of Sufi saint Kamaal-ud-din Malawi in Dhar in Madhya Pradesh, and the 14th-century mosque beside it are at the centre of a century-long dispute, with Hindus claiming the complex as the 'Bhojshala' of the legendary Raja Bhoj. The dispute has been magnified since the 1990s alongside communal politics taking deeper roots in the Malwa region.

The term 'Bhojshala' first appeared in a 1903 paper by superintendent of education K.K. Lele, who was also in charge of an archaeology office set up by Captain Earnest Barnes, the British political agent in the Dhar princely state. Lele's term,

DHAR, MP

KAMAAL MAULA/ BHOJSHALA

PANKAJ TIWARI

